

---

**EDUCATIONAL LEADERSHIP AND INSTRUCTIONAL BEST PRACTICES IN NORTH-CENTRAL, NIGERIA****Nimota Jibola Kadir ABDULLAHI (Ph.D)**

Department of Educational Management

Faculty of Education

University of Ilorin, Ilorin

Tel: 08037551059

Email: [Abdullahi.njk@unilorin.edu.ng](mailto:Abdullahi.njk@unilorin.edu.ng)[neematabdullahi@gmail.com](mailto:neematabdullahi@gmail.com)

---

**Abstract**

*This study examined educational leadership and instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria. The purpose of the study was to investigate the relationship between educational leadership and instructional best practices. To achieve this, two hypotheses were formulated and tested. Descriptive research design was used for the study. Sample of 375 head teachers and 384 teachers were proportionally selected in the seven states that make up north-central with the use of Research Advisor (2006), table of determining sample size of known population. Stratified random sampling technique was used to select head teachers and teachers of the sampled public primary schools so as to ensure that every member of the population has equal opportunity and right of being selected. T-test statistical analysis was used to analyse the collected data. The findings of the study showed that there was no significant difference between provision of instructional resource, staff development and instructional best practices in Nigeria. It was, therefore, recommended that head teacher and teachers should continue to provide and use appropriate instructional resources for effective instructional best practices as to ensure efficient staff development in order to increase productivity of staff.*

**Keywords:** *Instructional resource, staff development, best practices, leadership, Nigeria*

---

**Introduction**

The success of the school system is centred on the establishment of conducive working environment toward the enhancement of productive capacities of people at work. The primary aim of an educational leader is to secure suitable and appropriate teachers and support staff to carry out the task of educating the learners to the standard expected by the parents and the society. Quality learning depends on the adequate provision of instructional materials and development of professional teachers. The achievement of instructional best practice purposes is dependent upon the extent to which all personnel develop and how instructional resources are satisfactorily provided. The importance of educational leadership should aim at coordinating the activities of human resources so that each staff makes his/her best contributions to the success of the organisation.

The society exhibits a lot of expectations from teachers to impart knowledge to the learners and instil discipline and sound moral values in their children toward improved community development. All these expectations indicate that teaching is a very difficult task due to the fact that teaching deals with behaviour modification and change among learners. Therefore, there is obvious need for teachers to play the teaching role, guidance role and administrative role so as to ensure effective instructional best practices.

Numerous studies have been carried out in the area of educational leadership and instruction. Liisa (2016) viewed instructional leadership as a way of achieving students' success. Graczewski, Knudson and Holtzman (2009) conducted a similar study on the influence and usefulness of instructional leadership in practice. Salo, Nyland and Segerstrom (2014)

investigated instructional leadership on the architectures practice. Syarwan and Maznah (2015) wrote a treatise on the excellent school principal and instructional leadership practice. Mixed method design was used in the study.

Samples of 120 teachers, 4 principals, 4 vice principals and 4 head of school committees were selected for interviews. The findings revealed that principals practise effective instructional leadership in Aceh Schools in Indonesia. Abdullahi (2020) investigated how educational leadership behaviour influences community engagement in Kwara State. Quantitative research design was used in the study. The population sample of 364 teachers was randomly selected in the study.

The data collected were analysed using Pearson correlation and linear regression analysis. The findings show that effective communication, participatory decision-making and interpersonal relationship were significantly correlated with community engagement. However, there are few, if any, or possibly no research that has focused on educational leadership for instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria. In essence, no work so far that have given attention to provision of instructional material and staff development as critical variables to measure educational leadership as well as using high standard expectation and quality learning as indices to measure instructional best practices. Another noticeable gap that warranted this study is that the locale or area of study of this study differs considerably from the earlier studies. Therefore, this study endeavoured to fill the gaps left by the previous scholars.

### **Objectives of the Study**

- 1) To investigate the relationship between provision of instructional resources and instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria
- 2) To examine the relationship between staff development and instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria.

### **Research Questions**

- 1) Does provision of instructional resources improve instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria?
- 2) Does staff development enhance instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria?

### **Research Hypotheses**

The following research hypotheses were formulated to guide the conduct of this study.

- (1) There is no significant difference between the mean scores of head teachers and teachers on provision of instructional resources and instructional best practices in North-central
- (2) There is no significant difference between the mean scores of head teachers and teachers on staff development and instructional best practices in North-central.

### **Literature Review**

#### *Educational Leadership*

Leadership is generally seen as the act of persuading people to strive keenly towards the achievement of organisational goals. Leadership is an important human component in an organised system which is developed through training. It is important for educational leaders to have the ability to inspire or get members of the school community to work together in order to realise instructional best practices. Leadership can be seen as the process of influencing the activities of an individual or group towards the attainment of organisational goals (Okorie, 2010). This implies that leadership occurs in any moment an individual attempts to influence the behaviour of another person or group. Educational leadership refers to the head and nerve centre of learning institution that is responsible for effective utilisation of both human and material resources so as to achieve the institutional goals and objectives (Abdullahi, 2020). Great educational leaders must fully support the staff by encouraging them to continually learn, develop as well as become leaders so as to be more engaged, efficient and more productive.

Instructional resources in teaching generally make the instructional process easier in all subjects. It is required for teachers to make appropriate use of different types of instructional materials to ensure instructional best practices. Instructional resources are both human and non-human resources that teachers use to add value to students' life (Yusuf & Ogunlade, 2016). Instructional resources are vital for improving instructional best practices by exposing learners to a wide range of learning activities, widening learners' learning experience, retaining learners' attention as well as facilitating increased interest in learning (Bassey & Amie-Ogan, 2019). In this age of technology, learners need and want to know many things. Lesson becomes more interesting when concrete objects are used rather than oratory words from teachers which are easily forgotten. Instructional materials are resources inside and outside immediate classroom environment which are used to broaden and enrich the learning experience of learners (Abdullahi, 2020).

Staff development is a key element to successful instructional best practices. Staff development in the school context refers to the programmes designed for the continuous improvement of skills and job performance of staff (Abdullahi, Muritala, Ojo & Lawal, 2016, Ekpoh, Edet & Nkama, 2013). It can be seen as the process of developing qualities in human resources to be productive and therefore, contribute to instructional best practices toward the attainment of stated educational goals (Okeke, 2010). Staff development is concerned with the development of human capacities in order to grow and contribute to the development of their environment (Gabriel, 2004). Staff development generally is the process that ensures continuous increase in knowledge, skills and competences required for effectively carrying out task and duties.

Instructional best practices refer to increase in students' engagement in learning, implementing flexible teaching methods and setting high academic standards as well as

making learners understand the relevance of learning (Legters, Balfanz & McPartland, 2002). This implies that instructional best practice is an individual activities and programmatic strategies to realise positive change in learners' academic behaviours towards the achievement of predetermined goals and objectives. Instructional best practices are specific teaching strategies used by teachers to effectively guide learning towards the realisation of educational goals (Bassey & Amie-Ogan, 2019).

### **Theoretical Framework**

The theoretical contribution of this study is based on Path-Goal theory of leadership posited by House and Mitchell (1974) as cited by Abdullahi (2020). The theory holds that leader can facilitate job performance by showing staff members how their performance directly affects their receiving desired rewards with the use of four leadership behaviours which includes (i) directive (ii) supportive (iii) participative and (iv) achievement oriented.

This can be applied in education setting in that, a leader's behaviour can contribute to staff's satisfaction which in turn increases goal attainment. To achieve instructional best practices, educational leaders may employ all the four behaviours in different situations. For instance, a leader may employ directive behaviour when supervising an inexperienced teacher by providing necessary materials, guidance, coaching or removing barriers along the path; supportive behaviour when supervising a well-trained staff (staff development); and participative behaviour when dealing with experienced worker who is aware of the goals to be achieved (achievement oriented). This study is anchored on the Path-Goal theory such that it focuses primarily on how leaders can increase staff motivation and job satisfaction (instructional best practices) by clarifying performance goals and the path to attain the goals.

## Methodology

### Research Design

The descriptive survey research design was used in this study. The design was considered suitable because it will enable the researcher to examine the interaction that exist provision of instructional resources, staff development and instructional best practices. Also, the design will create a chance to get opinion of the sample population, and analyse the data collected with the use of proper data analysis techniques and reach a rational conclusion about the population from the findings of the study (Gorard, 2013).

### Population and Sampling Techniques

This study focused on public primary schools in North-Central, Nigeria, which comprised

12,775 primary schools. The target population of this study consists of 12,775 head teachers and 93,301 teachers in public primary schools in North-Central. Sample of 375 head teachers and 384 teachers were selected with the use of Research Advisor (2006) table of determining sample size of known population. Proportional random sampling technique was used to select sample of 375 head teachers and 384 teachers in each State by selecting the sample proportionally from the population as shown in Table 1. Stratified random sampling technique was used to select primary school head teachers and teachers from the sample schools in order to safeguard the fact that every member of the population has equal right and opportunity of being selected.

Table 1: *Population Sample of Head Teachers and Teachers of Primary Education*

| S/N | North-Central States | Number of primary schools | Selected head teachers | Number of teachers | Selected teachers |
|-----|----------------------|---------------------------|------------------------|--------------------|-------------------|
| 1   | Benue                | 2,661                     | 78                     | 4,344              | 18                |
| 2   | FCT                  | 495                       | 15                     | 7,172              | 29                |
| 3   | Kogi                 | 2,096                     | 62                     | 13,778             | 57                |
| 4   | Kwara                | 1,406                     | 41                     | 17,274             | 71                |
| 5   | Nasarawa             | 1,278                     | 37                     | 25,217             | 104               |
| 6   | Niger                | 2,834                     | 83                     | 16,320             | 67                |
| 7   | Plateau              | 2,005                     | 59                     | 9,196              | 38                |
|     | Total                | 12,775                    | 375                    | 93,301             | 384               |

Source: Universal Basic Education Commission (2019)

### Instrument

A self-designed questionnaire titled "Educational Leadership Questionnaire" (ELQ) was the instrument used for data collection. A total number of 11 items were used to measure educational leadership with two subscales: instructional resources (6 items) and staff development (5 items). Also, the items of questionnaire regarding instructional best practices were concluded from Lynne (2012) on quality teaching and high standard expectations. It comprised 10 items with two components: quality teaching (5 items) and high standard expectations (5 items). The head

teachers and teachers responded to the items on a four (4) point Likert-type scale as follows: Strongly Agree (4), Agree (3), Disagree (2) and Strong Disagree (1). The criterion mean is given thus:  $4 + 3 + 2 + 1 / 4 = 2.50$ . The criterion mean depicts that any item that is above or equal to the criterion mean value of 2.50 is agreed while the one below the criterion mean value is disagreed by the respondent. According to Allen and Christopher (2007), the 4-point Likert scale answer format was easier and faster to fill than 5 to 7-point scales answer format.

### Validity and Reliability

The instrument was validated by two experts in the Department of Educational Management and two experts in tests, Measurement and Evaluation in Faculty of Education, University of Ilorin, Nigeria to determine the amount and frequency of each person's agreement with the questionnaire's items. The adjustment of items by rephrasing the statement was done according to opinions from four academic staff who reviewed the instrument. Also, 30 revised copies were further administered on head teachers and

teachers who are part of the sample to observe their understanding of the items of instructions so as to detect if there is any difficulty that may arise in filling the questionnaire. Thus, some suggestions made were corrected properly before sending out the final copies. Cronbach's alpha test was used to test the reliability of the items. As shown in Table 2, the value for Cronbach's alpha for this study was proved to be consistent and reliable.

**Table 2: Reliability Test for ELQ and IBPQ**

| Variables                    | Sub-variable               | No of Items | Cronbach's Alpha | Decision                              |
|------------------------------|----------------------------|-------------|------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Educational Leadership       | Instructional resources    | 6           | 0.86             | All items are consistent and reliable |
|                              | Staff development          | 5           | 0.84             | All items are consistent and reliable |
| Instructional Best Practices | Quality teaching           | 5           | 0.84             | All items are consistent and reliable |
|                              | High standard expectations | 5           | 0.80             | All items are consistent and reliable |

Table 2 shows the results of the reliability test for ELQ educational leadership variables, the Cronbach's Alpha for the sub-variables are 0.86 for instructional resources and 0.84 for staff development. Based on instructional best practices IBPQ variables, the Cronbach's Alpha value for the sub-variables are 0.84 for quality teaching and 0.80 for high standard expectations. Values above 0.70 are considered consistent and reliable (Brannen, 2017; Denzin & Yvonna, 2000; Miller, Poole, Seibold, Myers, Hee Sun, & Monge, 2011).

#### **Data Collection Procedure**

The questionnaires were administered on the participants of the sample primary schools with the help of three trained research assistants. In order to ensure maximum response rate, the objectives of the research and instructions on how to respond to questions were clearly explained to participants. This effort brought about full participation of the participants. The exercise of data collection was smoothly completed within two weeks since questionnaires were personally administered by researchers,

trained research assistants and with the help of colleagues in the seven States' public primary schools. In the guidelines provided by Williams and James (2006), this study emphasised the ethical issues in guaranteeing anonymity and privacy of their responses.

#### **Data Analysis**

Data collected for the study were analysed using descriptive and t-test statistical analysis. Statistical Package for Social Sciences (SPSS version 23) was used for statistical analysis. Descriptive statistics using means and standard deviation was used to answer the research questions which are aimed at analysing educational leadership in terms of two sub-variables, namely, instructional resources and staff development. T-test statistical analysis was used to test the hypotheses at (0.5) significant level to determine the rejection or acceptance of the hypotheses

#### **Findings**

**Research Question1:** Does provision of instructional resources improve instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria?

Table 3 presents the mean and standard deviation of provision of instructional resources and instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria.

**Table 3:** *Provision of Instructional Resources*

| S/N | Provision of Instruction Resources                                                | Head teachers' Responses |       | Teachers' Responses |       | Decision |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------|---------------------|-------|----------|
|     |                                                                                   | Mean                     | SD    | Mean                | SD    |          |
| 1   | Instructional resource helps learners acquire fact and develop cognitive process. | 3.16                     | 0.804 | 2.94                | 0.922 | Agreed   |
| 2   | Enhances learners' attainment of instructional objective.                         | 3.22                     | 0.756 | 2.92                | 0.979 | Agreed   |
| 3   | Helps teachers and learners achieve meaningful and productive learning.           | 3.17                     | 0.723 | 2.89                | 0.973 | Agreed   |
| 4   | Instructional resource has positive effects on instructional best practices.      | 3.16                     | 0.805 | 2.77                | 1.033 | Agreed   |
| 5   | Enriches knowledge and skills of learners                                         | 2.85                     | 1.035 | 3.18                | 0.820 | Agreed   |
| 6   | Improves teacher's self-efficacy.                                                 | 3.19                     | 0.786 | 3.23                | 0.786 | Agreed   |
|     | Overall Mean                                                                      | 3.13                     | 0.818 | 2.99                | 0.918 |          |

The overall perception of the head teachers and teachers on provision of instructional resource as shown in Table 3 is interpreted as "Agreed" ( $M = 3.13$ ,  $SD = 0.818$ ) and ( $M = 2.99$ ,  $SD = 0.918$ ). This reveals that head teachers and teachers agreed that provision of instructional resource improves instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria. Also, all the responses obtained mean values higher than the criterion mean value of 2.50. This shows that the head teachers and teachers agreed that provision instructional resources (i) helps learners acquire fact and develop cognitive process ( $M = 3.16$ ,  $SD = 0.804$ ) and ( $M = 2.94$ ,  $SD = 0.922$ ), ii) enhances learners' attainment of instructional objectives ( $M =$  *Staff Development*

$3.22$ ,  $SD = 0.756$ ) and ( $M = 2.92$ ,  $SD = 0.979$ ), iii) helps teachers and learners achieve meaningful and productive learning ( $M = 3.17$ ,  $SD = 0.723$ ) and ( $M = 2.89$ ,  $SD = 0.973$ ), iv) instructional resources have positive effects on instructional best practices ( $M = 3.16$ ,  $SD = 0.805$ ) and ( $M = 2.77$ ,  $SD = 1.033$ ), v) enriches knowledge and skills of learners ( $M = 2.85$ ,  $SD = 1.035$ ) and ( $M = 3.18$ ,  $SD = 0.820$ ) vi) improves teacher's self-efficacy ( $M = 3.19$ ,  $SD = 0.786$ ) and ( $M = 3.23$ ,  $SD = 0.786$ ).

Table 4

**Research Question 2:** Does staff development enhance instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria?

| S/N | Staff Development                                                                  | Head teachers Responses |       | Teachers Responses |       | Decision |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------|--------------------|-------|----------|
|     |                                                                                    | Mean                    | SD    | Mean               | SD    |          |
| 1   | Staff development increases productivity of staff by influencing their behaviour.  | 2.97                    | 0.944 | 2.88               | 0.981 | Agreed   |
| 2   | Equips teachers with the necessary skills to enable them achieve reasonable goals. | 3.17                    | 0.757 | 3.19               | 0.778 | Agreed   |
| 3   | Facilitates the needed change from outdated pattern of work to modern techniques.  | 3.15                    | 0.785 | 3.15               | 0.786 | Agreed   |
| 4   | Boosts staff morale and enhances their self-investment in their teaching career.   | 3.19                    | 0.809 | 3.20               | 0.792 | Agreed   |
| 5   | Helps to raise personal prestige of individual teachers.                           | 3.19                    | 0.806 | 3.22               | 0.806 | Agreed   |
|     | overall Mean                                                                       | 3.13                    | 0.820 | 3.13               | 0.829 |          |

The overall perception of the head teachers and teachers on staff development as shown in Table 4 is interpreted as “Agreed” ( $M = 3.13$ ,  $SD = 0.820$ ) and ( $M = 3.13$ ,  $SD = 0.829$ ). This reveals that head teachers and teachers agreed that staff development enhanced instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria. Also, all the responses obtained mean values higher than the criterion mean value of 2.50. This shows that the head teachers and teachers agreed that staff development (i) increases productivity of staff by influencing their behaviour ( $M = 2.97$ ,  $SD = 0.944$ ) and ( $M = 2.88$ ,  $SD = 0.981$ ), ii) equips teachers with the necessary skills to enable them achieve reasonable goals ( $M = 3.17$ ,  $SD = 0.757$ ) and ( $M = 3.19$ ,  $SD = 0.778$ ), iii) facilitates the needed change from outdated pattern of work to modern techniques ( $M = 3.15$ ,  $SD = 0.785$ ) and ( $M = 3.15$ ,  $SD = 0.786$ ), iv) boosts staff morale and enhances their self-investment in their teaching career ( $M = 3.19$ ,  $SD = 0.809$ ) and ( $M = 3.22$ ,  $SD = 0.806$ ), v) helps to raise personal

prestige of individual teachers ( $M = 3.19$ ,  $SD = 0.806$ ) and ( $M = 3.22$ ,  $SD = 0.806$ ).

### Hypothesis Testing

$H_{01}$ : There is no significant difference between the mean scores of head teachers and teachers on provision of instructional resources and instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria.

$H_{02}$ : There is no significant difference between the mean scores of head teachers and teachers on staff development and instructional best practices in North-central.

T-test statistical analysis was used to test the set hypotheses as follow:

$H_{01}$ : There is no significant difference between the mean scores of head teachers and teachers on provision of instructional resource and instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria.

**Table 5: External Supervision and Management of Primary Education Improvement.**

| Variable      | N   | $\bar{x}$ | SD    | Df  | Tcal | t-crit | Decision |
|---------------|-----|-----------|-------|-----|------|--------|----------|
| Head teachers | 375 | 3.13      | 0.818 | 757 | 0.89 | 1.96   | Accepted |
| Teachers      | 384 | 2.99      | 0.918 |     |      |        |          |

Table 5 indicates the t-test analysis between the mean scores of head teachers' and teachers' responses on provision of instructional resource and instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria. The t-calculated value of 0.89 is less than t-critical value of 1.96. This means that there is no significant difference between the responses of head teachers and teachers on provision of instructional resources and instructional best practices. Therefore, the null hypothesis which

states that there is no significant difference between provision of instructional resources and instructional best practices in North-central is accepted.

**H<sub>02</sub>:** There is no significant difference between the mean scores of head teachers and teachers on staff development and instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria.

**Table 6: Staff Development and Instructional Best Practices**

| Variable      | N   | $\bar{x}$ | SD    | Df  | T-cal | t-crit | Decision |
|---------------|-----|-----------|-------|-----|-------|--------|----------|
| Head teachers | 375 | 3.13      | 0.820 | 757 | 0.82  | 1.96   | Accepted |
| Teachers      | 384 | 3.13      | 0.829 |     |       |        |          |

Table 6 indicates the t-test analysis between the mean scores of head teachers' and teachers' responses on staff development and instructional best practices in North-central. The t-calculated value of 0.82 is less than t-critical value 1.96. This means that there is no significant difference between the responses of head teachers and teachers on staff development and instructional best practices in North-central. Therefore, the null hypothesis which states that there is no significant difference between staff development and instructional best practices in North-central is accepted.

### Discussion

The findings of this study revealed that educational leadership has immense effects on instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria. The result of research question one and findings in Table 3 revealed that provision of instructional resources improve instructional best practices in North-central, in that instructional resources help learners

acquire facts and develop cognitive process, enhances learners' attainment of instructional objective, help teachers and learners achieve meaningful and productive learning, provides positive effects on instructional best practices, enriches knowledge and skills of learners as well as improve teacher's self-efficacy. Results from hypothesis one showed that there is no significant different between the provision of instructional resources and instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria. The findings are in line with Bassey and Amie-Ogah (2019) that instructional resources facilitate effective instructional best practices in institutions of learning. This finding also conforms to Abdullahi (2020) that instructional resources help in the effective management of best practices in elementary schools.

The findings in Table 4 show that staff development enhances instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria, in that it increases productivity of staff by influencing their behaviour, equipping teachers with the

necessary skills to enable them achieve reasonable goals, facilitating the needed change from outdated pattern of work to modern techniques, boosting staff morale and enhancing their self-investment in their teaching career as well as helping to raise personal prestige of individual teachers. Result from hypothesis two shows that there is no significant difference between staff development and instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria. The findings agreed with Rhodes, Comic, Milburn and Lowe (2009) that effective educational leadership improves school climate as well as instructional best practices. Also, the findings are in line with Salo, Nyland and Stjernstrom (2014) that staff developments encourage and support teachers to improve professional practice continuously.

### Recommendations

Based on the findings of this study, the following recommendations were made:

1. Head teachers and teachers should continue to provide and use appropriate instructional resources for effective instructional best practices so as to help learners acquire facts and develop cognitive process, enhance learners' attainment of instructional objective, help teachers and learners achieve meaningful and productive learning, provide positive effects on instructional best practices, enrich knowledge and skills of learners as well as improve teacher's self-efficacy.
2. Head teachers should continue to ensure efficient staff development so as to increase productivity of staff by influencing their behaviour, equip teachers with the necessary skills to enable them achieve reasonable goals, facilitate the needed change from outdated pattern of work to modern techniques, boosts staff morale and enhances their self-investment in their teaching carrier as well as helps to raise personal prestige of individual teachers

### Implications and Conclusion

The findings of this study will be of benefit to school heads, teachers, government and stakeholders in education. These findings may assist the government, stakeholders and head teachers to sufficiently provide the needed instructional resources for teachers to efficiently improve instructional best practices so as to achieve stated educational goals and objectives. Also, it will help the teachers to appraise their knowledge for effective instructional best practices.

Furthermore, these findings will be of advantage to researchers as it would give a sound foundation for further research. This paper emphasises educational leadership and instructional best practices in North-central, Nigeria. The findings revealed that participants agreed that educational leadership in terms of provision of instructional resources and staff development improve and enhance instructional best practices. This study, like other studies, has some limitations, thus, further researchers can carry out this study in other institutions of learning, using different indices as variables to measure educational leadership aside the variables used in this study.

### References

- Abdullahi, N. J. K., (2020). Ethical Leadership and staff innovative behaviour in Nigeria. *Journal of Social Sciences and Humanities*, 39(1), 1-19.
- Abdullahi, N. J. K., Muritala, A. T., Ojo, O. J. & Lawal, A. A. (2016). Staff development programmes and teachers' job performance in lower basic schools in Kwara State, Nigeria. *Journal of Humanities and Education*, 1(1), 67-75.
- Abdullahi, N. J. K., (2020). Instructional media and management of elementary school education in Kwara State, Nigeria. *Indonesian Journal of Elementary Teacher Education*, 1(1), 9-26.
- Allen, I. E. & Christopher, A. S. (2007). Likert scales and data analyses. *Quality Progress*, 40(7), 64-65.

- Bassey, L. G., Amie-Ogan, O. T. (2019). Availability and utilization of instructional materials for effective teaching in public junior secondary schools in Port Harcourt metropolis, River State. *International Journal of Innovative, social and Science Education Research*, 7(3), 83-89.
- Brannen, J. (2017). *Mixing methods: Qualitative and quantitative research*. Retrieved from <https://www.taylorfrancis.com/book/9781351917186>.
- Denzin, N. K. & Yvonna, S. L. (2000). *Handbook of qualitative research* (2<sup>nd</sup> ed.). Thousand Oaks, CA: Sage.
- Ekpoh, U. I., Edet, A. & Nkama, V. I. (2013). Staff development programme and school teachers' job performance in Oyo metropolis. *Journal of Education and practice*, 4(12), 217- 222.
- Gabriel, T. E. (2004). *Principals' skills and teachers' effectiveness*. Enugu: Bob Press.
- Graczewski, C., Knudson, J., & Holtzman, D. J. (2009). Instructional leadership in practice: What does it look like and what influence does it have? *Journal of Education for Students Placed at Risk*, 14(1), 72-96. doi:10.1080/10824660802715460
- Gorard, S. (2013). *Research design: Creating robust approaches for social sciences*. Thousand Oaks. CA: Sage.
- House, R. J. & Mitchell, T. R. (1974). Path-goal theory of leadership. *Journal of Contemporary Business*, 3, 1-97.
- Legters, N., Balfanz, R., & McPartland, J. (2002). *Solution for failing high schools: Converging vision and promising models*. Baltimore, MD: Center for Social Organisation of Schools. Johns Hopkins University.
- Lissa, B. (2016). Student success through instructional leadership. *Journal of Graduate Studies in Education*, 8(2), 42-45.
- Lynne, M. B. (2012). Best practices for effective schools. Retrieves from urban health. [Jhu.edu/PDFs/media/best\\_practices/effective\\_schools.pdf](http://Jhu.edu/PDFs/media/best_practices/effective_schools.pdf) on 7/08/2020.
- Miller, V. D., Poole, M. S., Seibold, D. R., Myers, K. K., Hee Sun, P., & Monge, P. (2011). Advancing research in organisational communication through qualitative methodology. *Management Communication Quarterly*, 25(1), 4-58.
- Okeke, F. N. (2010). Staff personnel administration. In I.L. Anukam, P.O.O. Okunamiri & R.N.O. Ogbonna. (Eds.) *Basic text on educational management*. Imo State, EeHech Versatile Publishers.
- Okorie, A. N. (2010). Administrative theories. In F. Durosaro & S. Ogunsaju (eds.). *The craft of educational management*. INDEMAC Print Media, Kwara State.
- Research Advisor (2006). Sample size table. Retrieved from <http://WWW.research-advisors.com>
- Rhodes, J., Comic, P., Milburn, M., & Lowe, S. (2009). Improving middle school climate through teacher-centered change. *Journal of Community Psychology*, 37(6), 711-724.
- Salo, P., Nyland, J. & Segerstrom, E. (2014). On the practice architectures of instructional leadership. *Educational Management, Administration and Leadership*, 43(4), 490-506. doi:10.1177/17411432145230010.
- Syarwan, A., & Maznah. H. (2015). Instructional leadership practices of the excellent school principals in Aceh, Indonesia: Managing the instructional program. *International Journal of Indonesian Studies*, 2, 1-15.
- William, M. K. T. & James, P. D. (2006). *The research methods knowledge base* (3<sup>rd</sup> Ed.). Cincinnati, OH: Atomic Dog Publishing Inc.
- Yusuf, M. O., Ogunlade, O. O. (2016). Principles of selection, adaptation and improvisation of instructional resources. In A. A. Adegoke, R. A. Lawal, A. G. A. S. Oladosu & A. A. Jekayinfa (eds.). *Introduction to teaching methodology*. Haytee Press and Publishing Company Nigeria Ltd, Ilorin Kwara State, Nigeria.